

FAMILY STUDIES

OVERVIEW

In the social sciences and humanities curriculum, family studies is a multidisciplinary subject area that encompasses four areas: fashion and housing; food and nutrition; general family studies; and raising and caring for children. The topics covered in these areas include, among others: textile production; the functions and design of clothing; the fashion industry; issues related to housing; interior design; the role of nutrition in health; the relationship between food and culture; human and family interactions and development; life management skills; various types of relationships; and considerations related to raising and caring for children.

In family studies courses, students learn about laws and policies that affect individuals and families in Canada and around the world. They also become familiar with the theoretical perspectives and practical research that underpin our understandings of individual and family development. Family studies courses also integrate theory and practical skills. Many expectations can be achieved through practical experiences both in the classroom and in co-op placements, some of which may be affiliated with Specialist High Skills Majors programs.

All courses in family studies encourage students to develop critical and creative thinking skills. Students are given opportunities to deepen their understanding of relevant issues and to develop practical skills, including research and inquiry skills. Students are encouraged to explore a range of perspectives and approaches and to develop the habits of mind that enhance individual, family, and community well-being and contribute to lifelong learning.

FASHION AND HOUSING

Understanding Fashion, Grade 11

College Preparation

HNC3C

This course introduces students to the world of fashion. Students will gain an understanding of theories related to fashion trends and of how culture, media, fashion cycles, retailing, and social and environmental factors influence fashion trends and consumer behaviour. Students will use various tools, technologies, and techniques safely and correctly to create fashion items. In addition, students will apply knowledge of fibres, fabrics, and the elements and principles of design when creating and assessing fashion-related products. Students will develop research skills as they investigate topics related to fashion.

Prerequisite: None

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to fashion, and formulate questions to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate social science research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to fashion (*e.g., cultural influences on dress, fashion cycles, fashion marketing, media and advertising, body image, fibre and fabric characteristics, elements and principles of design*) to identify topics for research and inquiry
- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their chosen topic
- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry
Teacher prompt: “If you wanted to research fashion marketing strategies, which types of goods would you want to consider (*e.g., sportswear, children’s wear, exclusive clothing lines*)? Why might a comparative approach be useful?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method, identify sources of information*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., interviews, observations, surveys, questionnaires, photographs in magazines, billboards*) and/or secondary sources (*e.g., textbooks, book reviews*)

- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or research question, and use it to focus their research

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

- A3.1** assess various aspects of information gathered from primary and secondary sources (*e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice*)
- A3.2** record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (*e.g., notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/digital records*)
- A3.3** analyse and interpret research information (*e.g., compare observations with predictions; determine whether common themes arise in research from/on different periods*)
- A3.4** demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (e.g., *determine whether their results support or contradict their hypothesis; weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question*)

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (e.g., *oral presentation, written research report, poster, multimedia presentation, web page*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

A4.2 use terms relating to fashion correctly (e.g., *fashion cycles, marketing, positional goods, pattern, dart, seam, gather, ease, line, colour, shape, texture*)

A4.3 clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (e.g., *write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow APA conventions for acknowledging sources (e.g., *generate a reference list in APA style, use in-text author-date citations*)

A4.4 demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills

Teacher prompts: “How might your results have differed if you had conducted a survey rather than made your own observations?”
“What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?”

B. INFLUENCES ON FASHION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Cultural Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of how culture influences fashion;
- B2. Media Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of how media influence fashion;
- B3. Fashion Cycles and Trends:** demonstrate an understanding of fashion cycles and trends and of factors that influence them.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Cultural Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify and describe garments and styles of personal adornment typical of various cultures (e.g., sari, turban, parka, kimono, ribbon shirt, dance shawl, kilt, hijab, burka, yarmulke, tattoos, scarification, piercings)

Teacher prompts: “What are the different styles of wearing hijab?” “What are some different methods of scarification?” “In what ways is the Muslim kufi similar to the Jewish yarmulke?”

- B1.2** explain how various garments and styles of personal adornment express a person’s cultural identity and heritage (e.g., kilts identify Scottish clans; items such as a hijab, burka, or kippah identify the religion of the wearer)

Teacher prompts: “How is clothing used to express different aspects of people’s identity?” “Why does a woman wear a hijab? Why does a man wear a yarmulke? Why is it significant that some women now wear yarmulkes?” “What is the significance of differences in styles of dress among groups who live in or come from India?” “What sorts of dress are worn for cultural celebrations in your community? Why?”

- B1.3** describe ways in which current fashion trends reflect aspects of garments and adornment associated with various cultures (e.g., the Mandarin collar, moccasins, nose piercings, the keffiyeh, dashikis)

Teacher prompt: “What are some examples of dress from specific cultures that have been adopted by the mainstream fashion industry? What are some of the effects when the Western fashion industry adopts or appropriates such items?”

B2. Media Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** explain the ways in which different media (e.g., music videos, television shows, movies, the Internet, fashion magazines, billboards, window displays) influence the fashion industry and individual fashion choices

Teacher prompts: “To what extent does coverage of gala events such as award shows and celebrity weddings influence fashion trends?” “In what ways do popular fashion magazines, music videos, and TV programs affect your clothing choices?”

- B2.2** analyse how the media influence social norms with respect to fashion, and describe the effect these norms can have (e.g., how young pop stars wearing revealing clothing in music videos contributes to the hypersexualization of children)

Teacher prompts: “What messages do the mainstream media convey with regard to body size and fashion? With regard to gender roles and fashion? What impact might such messages have on adolescent girls and boys?” “How

have male and female models seen in the media changed over the past fifty years? Considering norms, values, and trends today, what do you think models might look like twenty years from now?"

B3. Fashion Cycles and Trends

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify and describe the stages of a fashion cycle (i.e., introduction, growth, maturity, decline, and obsolescence)

Teacher prompts: "Why are end-of-season sales common in clothing stores?" "How long is the typical fashion cycle for clothing items? Why might fashion cycles for teen and young adult clothing be shorter than those for clothing designed for other age groups?"

- B3.2** explain theories that have been developed to account for the origin and adoption of fashion trends (e.g., *trickle up, trickle down, trickle across*), and describe the use of these theories in the fashion business

Teacher prompt: "How are fashion theories used when predicting future trends? How do these theories influence fashion business decisions?"

- B3.3** analyse how social factors, including current events, influence fashion trends and cycles (e.g., *factors such as historical events, technological advances, economic factors, geographical factors, environmental issues*)

Teacher prompts: "In what ways have sports influenced fashion trends?" "How has concern for the environment affected current fashion trends?" "How do economic recessions or depressions affect attitudes towards luxury fashion items?"

C. MARKETING, ENVIRONMENTAL RESPONSIBILITY, AND CONSUMER BEHAVIOUR

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Consumer Behaviour and Fashion Marketing:** demonstrate an understanding of consumer behaviour and marketing strategies, including specific social marketing promotions, associated with the fashion industry;
- C2. Fibres, Fabrics, and the Environment:** demonstrate an understanding of fibres, fabrics, and finishes, and of the environmental impact associated with their production and use.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Consumer Behaviour and Fashion Marketing

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** explain the elements of marketing in the fashion industry (i.e., product, placement, price, promotion)

Teacher prompt: “What are some of the factors that marketers consider when deciding on the price of a fashion item? Why does a low price not necessarily lead to higher sales?”

- C1.2** explain strategies that fashion marketers use to create a sense of need among consumers, and describe the effects of these strategies (e.g., manufacturing demand for clothing that has “cool” labels/logos; convincing consumers to replace garments that are out of style rather than worn out; creating a market for positional goods, whose value is based on exclusivity, and knock-offs of these items)

Teacher prompts: “What type of running shoes do you wear? Why?” “What is meant by the term *positional goods* in the context of fashion? What impact do such goods have?” “When you view fashion advertisements, how can you determine which markets are being targeted and which groups are being excluded?”

- C1.3** explain how marketing in the fashion industry can affect consumer behaviour (e.g., *impulse buying, accessorizing, combination buying, buying items endorsed by celebrities*)

Teacher prompts: “Why do store window displays feature fully accessorized mannequins?” “Have you ever bought more items than you intended or needed because a store was having a sale? Have you ever made an impulse purchase of an item displayed near the cash register? What does this behaviour indicate about the effectiveness of these marketing strategies?”

- C1.4** describe strategies that consumers can use to make informed and responsible fashion purchases (e.g., *checking textile labels, comparison shopping, checking warranties/guarantees, wardrobe assessment, checking return policies, investigating the working conditions under which the garment was produced and sold*)

Teacher prompts: “What types of fashion items are covered by warranties/guarantees? Why is it important to be aware of such guarantees when shopping for such items?” “What constitutes a socially responsible fashion choice?” “To what extent do fair-trade products guarantee ethical working conditions?”

C1.5 analyse fashion promotions and products that raise awareness of social issues (e.g., *charity fashion shows such as Fashion Cares, ribbons symbolizing issues such as breast cancer and HIV/AIDS awareness, T-shirts with messages, reusable shopping bags*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some fashion products that promote awareness of environmental issues? How effective do you think they are?” “How and why might some fashion retail chains be motivated to develop social marketing promotions?”

C2. Fibres, Fabrics, and the Environment

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 identify the advantages and disadvantages of common natural and synthetic fibres (e.g., *cotton is lightweight, breathable, and easy to find, but it can shrink when washed and is easily creased; silk is hypoallergenic, breathable, and strong, but it is expensive and the fibres are weakened by perspiration; spandex increases the stretch of a garment, but it is not breathable; polyester is relatively inexpensive and holds its shape and colour, but it is not absorbent, does not breathe, and can cling as a result of static electricity*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some advantages and disadvantages of new fibres such as bamboo, soy, and hemp?” “Why is spandex particularly suitable for use in swimwear?” “When might you wear a garment made of Gore-tex? When would you not want to wear such a garment? Why?” “What are the advantages and disadvantages of down insulation?”

C2.2 describe characteristics of different types of woven fabrics (e.g., *canvas, chino, damask, linen, percale*), knit fabrics (e.g., *jersey, tricot, velour, boiled wool*), and non-woven fabrics (e.g., *leather, fur, felt*) used in various fashion products

Teacher prompts: “What are the main differences between canvas and percale?” “In what ways does jersey differ from velour?”

C2.3 describe characteristics of various types of dyes (e.g., *natural, acid, reactive, solvent*) and fabric finishes (e.g., *waterproof, flame-retardant, wrinkle-resistant, stain-resistant finishes*), and describe the effects they have on fabrics

Teacher prompts: “Why might some natural dyes have a more negative impact on the environment than some synthetic dyes?” “How do various fabric finishes affect the lifespan of a garment?” “Which fabric finishes would be desirable for a raincoat? Why?” “Which finishes enhance the appearance of a garment?”

C2.4 describe the environmental impact of the production, use, and care of various fibres and fabrics (e.g., *the impact of farming cotton, hemp, bamboo, sheep, silkworms; of the production process for various synthetic fabrics and dyes; of dry cleaning*)

Teacher prompts: “Which is more damaging to the environment – washing garments at home or having them dry cleaned? Why?” “What is the environmental impact of the chemicals used in stain-resistant finishes?” “What is the environmental impact of using dyes in the production of fibres?”

C2.5 describe strategies to reduce the environmental impact of the production of various fibres, fabrics, and finishes (e.g., *purchasing garments made from organic cotton or hemp, using plant-based dyes, buying second-hand clothes, limiting the use of stain-resistant fabric*)

C2.6 apply their knowledge of the basic characteristics of various fibres and fabrics and their environmental impact when choosing appropriate fabrics for various fashion products

Teacher prompts: “What is the purpose of your fashion product? Does that purpose narrow the range of fabrics that you might consider? Why or why not?” “How will the fabric that you have chosen complement the design of this product?”

D. DESIGN AND FASHION CONSTRUCTION SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Elements and Principles of Design:** demonstrate an understanding of the elements and principles of design, and of how they can be used to different effect in the creation of fashion products;
- D2. Tools and Technologies:** describe a variety of tools and technologies associated with the creation of fashion products, and use tools and technologies safely and correctly when creating such products;
- D3. Procedures, Skills, and Techniques:** demonstrate the ability to use appropriate procedures, skills, and techniques when creating fashion products.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Elements and Principles of Design

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** identify and describe the elements and principles of design as they apply to fashion products (*e.g., line, colour, shape, texture, balance, proportion, rhythm, emphasis, harmony*)

Teacher prompt: “What are some ways of using colour or texture to show contrast in a garment?”

- D1.2** analyse the impact that apparel and/or accessories reflecting various elements and principles of design can have on a person’s appearance and the impression he or she creates

Teacher prompts: “Why do horizontal lines on some garments make a person appear wider?” “Why does dark clothing make a person appear smaller?” “What is the effect of clothes or accessories in bright colours?”

- D1.3** apply the elements and principles of design when creating fashion-related products (*e.g., when creating fashion illustrations, fashion sketches, apparel for paper dolls of different body shapes; when designing a garment; when engaged in a sewing project*)

Teacher prompts: “Are you going to run the lines in your fabric horizontally or vertically in the garment you are creating? Why? What effect will that produce? How would the effect be different if the lines ran the other way?” “How can a fashion illustration that shows formal balance be modified to show informal balance in a similar garment?”

D2. Tools and Technologies

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** identify various tools and technologies used in the creation of fashion products, and describe their function (*e.g., measuring tape, seam ripper, scissors, pinking shears, iron, pressing ham, sewing machine, serger, loom, knitting needles, crochet hook*)

Teacher prompt: “What cutting tools are necessary to make clothing? What are the differences in the functions of various cutting tools?”

- D2.2** demonstrate the safe use of tools and technologies when creating fashion products (*e.g., keep pins in a pin cushion, store the iron on its heel when not in use, promptly replace blunt or bent needles in sewing machines or sergers*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important to replace a bent or dull needle on a sewing machine?” “When using a sewing machine, why is it important to wear safety glasses or tie back long hair?”

- D2.3** use tools and technologies correctly when creating fashion products (*e.g., tools and technologies associated with cutting, pressing, pinning, sewing, knitting, crocheting, felting, embroidering, dyeing*)

Teacher prompt: “How would you use a measuring tape to place a pattern piece correctly on fabric?”

D3. Procedures, Skills, and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 demonstrate the ability to follow preconstruction procedures (*e.g., measuring; interpreting patterns, including their abbreviations, and laying out patterns; selecting and preparing fabrics; fitting and altering patterns; understanding knitting, crocheting, or jewellery-making instructions*) when creating fashion products

Teacher prompt: “How would you use numeracy skills to measure a grainline or determine the number of metres of fabric required?”

D3.2 identify and describe basic skills and construction techniques used in the creation of

fashion products (*e.g., finishing seams, sewing darts, gathering and easing fabric, making buttonholes, sewing in zippers, hemming, reducing bulk, using stabilizers and interfacing*)

Teacher prompt: “What are the main differences between sewing in a conventional zipper and an invisible zipper?”

D3.3 demonstrate the ability to apply basic skills and construction techniques when creating fashion products (*e.g., finishing seams, sewing in zippers, hemming, using fasteners*)

Teacher prompts: “How can you determine how much seam allowance you will need?”
“What techniques can you use to ensure a straight hem in a garment you are sewing?”